BEYOND THE CALL

A real conversation. A bigger story.

SENIOR LEARNING DESIGNER LESSON PLAN

PROGRAMME	Beyond the Call	**DELIVERY**	1-day facilitated training
DURATION	7 hours total	**LEARNING TIME**	6 hours + 1-hour break
SOURCE BASIS	Supplied slide deck + activity pack	**FORMAT**	Facilitator-led, discussion, case practice

Design principle: preserve the supplied content, use the four documented activities, and make the day's timing explicit without inventing assessment items or scenario answers.

1. Session design at a glance

The session moves from customer experience and mindset into communication and listening, then into the SCORE call framework, practical call handling, complaint response, and ownership of the next step. Activities are placed where they let participants apply the ideas just introduced.

Learning outcomes (from the supplied deck)

- List the six communication barriers covered in the training.
- Name the three communication styles and explain the difference between open and closed questions.
- Recall the five SCORE steps and explain the purpose of each step.
- State the NPS formula: % Promoters − % Detractors.
- Demonstrate the SCORE process in a customer-call role-play.
- Replace unsuitable customer-service phrases with appropriate alternatives.
- Identify customer needs, intent, emotions, and communication gaps in a sample conversation.

- Choose whether an issue should be handled, escalated, or followed up, and write a response with empathy, positive language, and a clear next step.

Delivery assumptions and controls

- Clock plan: 09:00–16:00, including one 60-minute lunch break. The six hours outside lunch are facilitated learning time.
- The activity guide labels the timings for the icebreaker and Activities 1–4 as suggested. The lesson-plan timings below are a proposed allocation to fit the full day, not timings stated in the original activity files.
- The supplied activity guide identifies no standalone pre-assessment question file or formal post-assessment file. Use the pre-assessment slide with the assessment method already prepared by the facilitator; do not invent questions. End with an oral retrieval check against the stated objectives unless a formal assessment is supplied separately.
- Some slides display numerical claims without a confirmed primary source in the supplied material. If used, present them as claims displayed in the deck, not as universal or independently verified facts.

Materials and room setup

- Beyond_Call_Complete.pptx; display and audio if the video on slide 41 is used.
- Activity 1: Activity_1_Beyond_the_Request.pdf and Activity_1_Read_Between_the_Lines.pdf.
- Activity 2: Activity_2_Customer_Moment_Cards_FullBleed.pdf, Activity_2_First_Response_Lines_FullBleed.pdf, and Activity_2_Make_the_Response_Fit_FullBleed.pdf.
- Activity 3: The_Turning_Point_no_reflect.pdf, “Beyond the Call – The Turning Point Worksheet.png”, and “The Turning Point Workshop Flipchart.png”.
- Activity 4: Beyond_the_Call_Who_Owns_the_Next_Step.docx; four groups, one distinct scenario per group.
- Pens; flipchart markers for Activity 3; projector/screen; suitable seating for pairs and small groups.

2. Timed lesson plan

Proposed delivery window: 09:00–16:00 | 360 minutes of learning + 60-minute break. Slide references use the numbering in the supplied 75-slide deck.

TIME	MIN	SEGMENT	SLIDES	FACILITATOR ACTIONS	PARTICIPANT ACTIONS	MATERIALS / METHOD	EVIDENCE OF LEARNING
09:00–09:10	10	**Welcome and frame the day**	1	Set context: customer service is not only solving a request; the way the customer is heard and guided also shapes the experience. Preview the day’s flow and working agreements.	Listen; connect the theme to their customer-call role.	Facilitated opening; slide deck.	Participants can state the purpose of the session in their own words.
09:10–09:18	8	**Icebreaker: Pick One**	2–3	Ask each participant to choose one of the six approved questions. Invite short shares; make passing acceptable. Keep the pace light.	Choose one question and share briefly, or pass.	Whole-group sharing; slide 2–3. No handout.	Broad participation and a comfortable start.
09:18–09:28	10	**Pre-assessment**	4	Explain that this is a baseline, not a judgement. Administer the prepared assessment method without hints or answer explanations. The deck does not include the assessment items themselves.	Complete the supplied/prepared assessment independently.	Slide 4; assessment instrument must be provided separately.	Baseline responses collected; no coaching during completion.

TIME	MIN	SEGMENT	SLIDES	FACILITATOR ACTIONS	PARTICIPANT ACTIONS	MATERIALS / METHOD	EVIDENCE OF LEARNING
09:28–10:00	32	**Customer experience, churn and NPS**	5–22	Use customer experiences to surface what makes service feel good or poor. Cover customer service as a company-wide responsibility, churn reasons, the NPS scale and categories, and the knowledge–skills–attitude framing. Treat unsourced figures as claims shown in the deck, not universal facts.	Share examples; distinguish service-related churn from factors outside the company's control; explain the NPS categories/formula.	Slides 5–22; discussion.	Participants can state the NPS formula and explain why a customer experience can influence loyalty.
10:00–10:15	15	**Activity 1: Read Between the Lines**	—	Distribute the conversation case and five-question worksheet. Ask participants/pairs to identify the main concern, feelings, what has already happened, where trust may have been affected, and what could improve the experience. Debrief without supplying invented model answers.	Read the case, answer the worksheet, and share reasoning.	Activity_1_Beyond_the_Request.pdf + Activity_1_Read_Between_the_Lines.pdf; pens.	Responses address the customer's concern beyond the literal request.
10:15–10:40	25	**Attitude, behaviour and circle of influence**	23–31	Explain the cultural iceberg, habitual versus conscious responses, and the distinction between concern and influence. Use the examples shown in the slides; do not present the 85/7.5/7.5 or letter-value percentages as research findings. Close with a brief recap.	Reflect on a response they can influence during a difficult call; share one practical example.	Slides 23–31; guided reflection.	Participants identify at least one controllable behaviour in a customer interaction.
10:40–11:10	30	**Communication process, styles and barriers**	32–39	Walk through sender, message, encoding, channel, receiver, decoding, feedback and noise. Contrast aggressive, passive and assertive styles. Cover all six barriers: time, venue, linguistic, culture, emotional barriers and poor listening. Introduce verbal, paraverbal and non-verbal communication while qualifying unsupported percentage claims.	Classify examples; discuss which barriers may arise on calls and how to reduce misunderstanding.	Slides 32–39; questioning and discussion.	Participants name the three styles and six barriers; explain one way to reduce a communication gap.
11:10–11:30	20	**Activity 2: Customer Moments**	—	Form small groups. Give each group the four customer-moment cards, first-response lines and response-rewrite sheet. Groups choose one situation, select a fitting opening response, then improve it so the customer feels heard and understands the next step. Ask groups to explain why their response fits.	Discuss one customer situation; choose and rewrite a response collaboratively.	Three Activity 2 PDFs; print all three in colour, A4, single-sided.	Response is relevant to the situation and includes a clear, appropriate next step.
11:30–12:00	30	**Listening, empathy and HEAR**	40–48	Explain the three listening levels and the focus on content, intent and emotions. Cover care/empathy and each HEAR stage: Hearing, Empathize, Analyse, Respond. If using the video on slide 41, ensure playback is ready and use the time within this block.	Identify what an agent might miss by listening only to words; practise describing content, intent and emotion without assuming facts.	Slides 40–48; video on slide 41 if available.	Participants distinguish hearing from listening and recall HEAR in order.
12:00–13:00	**60**	**LUNCH BREAK**	**—**	**Pause formal learning. Resume promptly at 13:00.**	**Break.**	**No learning activity scheduled.**	**60 minutes protected.**

TIME	MIN	SEGMENT	SLIDES	FACILITATOR ACTIONS	PARTICIPANT ACTIONS	MATERIALS / METHOD	EVIDENCE OF LEARNING
13:00–13:35	35	**SCORE process: from listening to resolution**	49–56	Teach the five stages in order: Sincerely Listen; Care and Empathy; Open the Door with Questions; Resolve and Recommend; Effectively End the Call. Model how question choice supports understanding and how resolution should clarify what, why, results and agreement. Cover effective call closing.	Explain the purpose of each stage; improve the sample response to the bill concern; recap the sequence.	Slides 49–56; guided analysis.	Participants recall all five SCORE stages and explain their purpose.
13:35–14:05	30	**Call structure, hold protocol and etiquette**	57–65	Cover opening/body/ending, the before- and after-hold steps, inbound/outbound call types, and phone etiquette tips. Emphasize no interruption, avoiding jargon, listing alternatives, focusing on the call, repeating information back, avoiding dead air and not taking it personally.	Identify the correct stage or etiquette practice for brief examples raised by the facilitator.	Slides 57–65; facilitated questioning.	Participants can sequence a basic call and state key hold-protocol steps.
14:05–14:25	20	**Activity 3: The Turning Point**	—	Distribute the conversation case and worksheet. Ask participants to identify the moment the conversation starts to go off track and the agent choices that contribute. Debrief using the flipchart visual; capture participant observations rather than supplying unprovided model answers.	Read, annotate, discuss the turning point, then contribute to the group debrief.	The_Turning_Point_no_reflect.pdf; worksheet PNG; flipchart PNG.	Participants point to a specific moment and justify a better response.
14:25–14:45	20	**Complaint handling and angry customers**	68–72	Use the supplied slides to discuss dealing with angry customers, controlling emotions, remaining calm, not taking insults personally, listening and learning, speaking low and slow, assessing the situation, and resolving or consulting a manager when needed. Avoid adding a policy not present in the material.	Discuss how an agent can stay professional and assess the situation before acting.	Slides 68–72; facilitated discussion.	Participants identify a calm response behaviour and a reason to consult a manager.
14:45–15:00	15	**Activity 4: Who Owns the Next Step?**	—	Divide participants into four groups and assign a different scenario to each. Each group agrees whether to handle, escalate or follow up; what the agent should do next; and what to say. Reinforce realistic promises and continuing ownership when another team is involved.	Agree a decision, next action and customer message; present the rationale.	Beyond_the_Call_Who_Owns_the_Next_Step.docx; one scenario per group.	Each group gives a justified decision, next action and customer-facing message.
15:00–15:25	25	**The Next Right Step**	73	Use the slide as a transition into next-step thinking. Facilitate a short synthesis: based on the day's content, what does a customer need to know before a call can be considered well handled? Keep prompts anchored to SCORE, clarity, ownership and realistic commitments; do not introduce a new framework.	Synthesize the day's practices and share what the agent still owns after escalation or follow-up.	Slide 73; facilitated synthesis.	Participants connect the day's tools to a clear next step.
15:25–15:45	20	**Call tree scenario**	74	Display the supplied call-tree scenario slide and facilitate it using only the information visible in the deck. Invite participants to explain their reasoning. No separate scenario answer key or detailed instructions were identified in the supplied activity pack.	Discuss the scenario and explain the reasoning behind their choices.	Slide 74. Do not invent missing scenario details or a model answer.	Participants articulate a reasoned response based on the information provided.

TIME	MIN	SEGMENT	SLIDES	FACILITATOR ACTIONS	PARTICIPANT ACTIONS	MATERIALS / METHOD	EVIDENCE OF LEARNING
15:45–16:00	15	Recap and close	31, 56	Ask participants to retrieve key learning: six barriers, three styles, HEAR, SCORE, open vs closed questions, and handle/escalate/follow up. Invite one commitment for a future call. This is an oral retrieval check, not a formal post-assessment.	Answer brief recall prompts and state one behaviour they will apply.	Recap slides; no additional handout required.	Evidence of recall and a specific intended behaviour.

3. Activity delivery cards

Activity 1 — Read Between the Lines

15 minutes (proposed; guide suggests 12–15 min)

Purpose: identify the customer's main concern, feelings, what has already happened, where trust may have been affected, and what could improve the experience.

Set-up: one conversation case and one five-question worksheet per participant or pair. Print both PDFs in colour on A4, single-sided.

Facilitation: participants read first, answer the five prompts, then share selected reasoning. Keep the debrief evidence-based; the guide explicitly does not provide model answers.

Activity 2 — Customer Moments

20 minutes (proposed; guide suggests 15–20 min)

Purpose: choose an opening response that fits the customer and situation, then improve it so the customer feels heard and understands the next step.

Set-up: small groups; provide all three PDFs. Print each in colour on A4, single-sided. Four situations include a delayed replacement card, app lockout, unexpected charge and missed promised update.

Facilitation: groups select a situation, compare the first-response lines, rewrite the response, and share one choice with rationale. Assess fit and clarity, not a single memorized sentence.

Activity 3 — The Turning Point

20 minutes (proposed; guide suggests 15–20 min)

Purpose: notice how the agent's choices affect the conversation and identify a better response.

Set-up: conversation case PDF, participant worksheet PNG, and workshop flipchart PNG. Print worksheet and case on A4; print flipchart large or display it. Bring pens/markers.

Facilitation: participants identify the turning point and explain what in the dialogue signals that the call has gone off track. Capture group ideas on the flipchart.

Activity 4 — Who Owns the Next Step?

15 minutes (proposed; guide suggests 15 min)

Purpose: decide whether to handle, escalate or follow up, while keeping ownership of the customer's next step clear.

Set-up: four groups, each with a different scenario sheet from the supplied Word file. Print in colour on A4, single-sided.

Facilitation: each group agrees the decision, next action and customer message. Challenge any promise that the scenario does not support. Debrief what the agent still owns when another team becomes involved.

4. Assessment and facilitation notes

Evidence to listen for

- Knowledge: participants accurately name communication barriers and styles, explain open/closed questions, recall HEAR and SCORE, and state the NPS formula.
- Application: participants identify customer content, intent and emotions without treating assumptions as facts; rewrite a response to fit the situation; and state a clear next step.
- Judgement: participants choose handle/escalate/follow up based on the scenario information and avoid guarantees the agent cannot make.
- Communication: participants use respectful language, acknowledge the concern, explain what happens next, and do not blame or dismiss the customer.

Content integrity / do-not-invent controls

- The supplied activity guide gives suggested timings for the icebreaker and Activities 1–4; all other timings in this plan are instructional-design allocations to fit the requested 7-hour day.
- No standalone pre-assessment question set or formal post-assessment instrument was present in the supplied ZIP activity pack. Confirm the pre-assessment tool before delivery; do not improvise scored questions and call them source material.
- Slide 74 is labelled “Call tree scenario”, but no detailed answer key or matching activity instructions were identified in the supplied activity pack. Facilitate only from what is shown on the slide.
- Statistics in the slide deck—including customer-service cost/retention claims, churn percentages, habit percentages, and communication percentage splits—are not all supported by primary citations in the supplied material. Preserve the slide’s message but qualify these figures rather than presenting them as universally established facts.
- The deck includes video/media. Test playback and sound before the session. The activity guide does not specify a separate video duration; the proposed listening block reserves time for it, but the exact video runtime should be confirmed.

Pre-session checklist

- ☐ Confirm the pre-assessment instrument and how responses will be collected.
- ☐ Test the deck, video/audio on slide 41, display, and any internet-dependent media.
- ☐ Print and collate each activity’s materials; keep Activity 2’s three files together.
- ☐ Prepare four distinct Activity 4 scenarios and assign one per group.
- ☐ Prepare pens and flipchart markers; make the Activity 3 flipchart visible to the room.
- ☐ Keep a visible timer; protect the 60-minute lunch and the final 15-minute recap.

5. Source inventory used

This plan is based on the uploaded 75-slide “Beyond the Call” presentation and the supplied ZIP pack. The ZIP includes the revised activity guide, Activity 1 case and worksheet PDFs, three Activity 2 PDFs, Activity 3 case PDF and two PNG visuals, and the Activity 4 Word scenario sheets. No outside framework or model answer has been added.